Neal T. Gillespie

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Hiring Committee
Napa County Library
580 Coombs Street
Napa, California 94559

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Associate I position with the Napa County Library. I hold a bachelor's degree from Chapman University in Orange, California, and a valid Class C California driver's license. I live in Austin now and can relocate to Napa County.

I have run programs and events for most of my working life. As California State Chair for Young Americans for Liberty, a national nonprofit that helps college students start and run political clubs on their own campuses, I organized and ran more than thirty programs, recruitment drives and meetings, and I was the person 90 or more members statewide came to with questions. I then became West Deputy Regional Director, supervising six state chairs across Arizona, Nevada and California, running weekly meetings and training student leaders and volunteers to deliver programs of their own. I recruited people into conferences as well, drawing 115 applications and 50 registrations for one national convention. Planning an event, publicizing it, getting people through the door and judging afterwards whether it worked is familiar work.

I have also spent years at a public service desk. At Chapman University's law school I staffed the registrar's window as the first person students spoke to, in person and over the phone, explained procedures, made referrals, and processed and approved more than five hundred transcripts, exam records and bar documents. I searched, filed and verified academic and bibliographic records that had to be exact and confidential, and I proctored exams, including individually proctored sittings for students with accommodations. As Donor Services Director at Young Americans for Liberty I managed 320 donor records and the money against them and supervised four staff through a year of public-facing service.

The technology side I can take on directly. At Young Americans for Liberty I built an archive out of the fundraising mail we send to donors, which sat in our office with no index before I took the job, and I designed a SQL database and a search page over it so anyone on staff can call up a mailing and find everything that went with it. In my own time I built the Free Knowledge Library, a public digital library of political literature drawn from across the political spectrum, where I designed the database and the classification scheme and built the catalog readers search.

At the University of Austin, a new university in Texas, I took in and recorded donated books for the campus library while it was still being built, and I led tours of the collection for visitors from academic and business backgrounds. I have begun the American Library Association's Library Support Staff Certification, and I start a certificate in Library and Information Services at Central Community College in the spring, with a master's in library and information science to follow. I can work evenings and weekends. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie